

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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The Christian's Pilgrimage – Psalm 84:6

Psalm 84:6-7 As they pass through the Baca Valley, he provides a spring for them. The rain even covers it with pools of water.

7 They are sustained as they travel along; each one appears before God in Zion. NET

OUR THEME:

THE PILGRIMAGE

- * A Pilgrimage according to Webster's dictionary means - the journey of a pilgrim on a long journey, especially a journey to a shrine or other sacred place. And our sacred place is Zion.
- * This journey as a follower of Christ – relates to the time frame from when we were saved until this present time (now).
- * And we are all just PASSING THROUGH this valley – “Baca” – ‘the valley of weeping’. We are not making it our home.

Things to remember about this Pilgrimage / journey.

1. As believers we are all pilgrims – on a pilgrimage- a journey in the pathway of the Lord Jesus Christ. Hebrews 11:13 *These all died in faith, not having received the promises, but having seen them afar off were assured of them, embraced them and confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth. (NKJV)*
2. That on this pilgrimage / journey towards God and our heavenly home - Zion – we do not allow ourselves to be distracted and lose sight of our ultimate objective, Zion.
3. Secondly that there are events that we experience in our pilgrimage that deeply affect our hearts and emotions producing tears and weeping.
- * But these things are only a part of the journey NOT the whole.
4. Thirdly, that we should NOT allow ourselves to be totally absorbed in any one of those events (joyous or sorrowful) and start to THINK / BELIEVE that it defines our destiny or the sum total of our lives. But this is not true.
5. We must not lose sight of where we are headed – we are on a pilgrimage to Mt Zion, God, to thousands of angels that are gathered, and to the Church of the first born etc.

Hebrews 12:22-24

22 But you have come to Mount Zion, to the heavenly Jerusalem, the city of the living God. You have come to thousands upon thousands of angels in joyful assembly, 23 to the church of the firstborn, whose names are written in heaven. You have come to God, the judge of all men, to the spirits of righteous men made perfect, 24 to Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel. NIV

THE VALLEY OF BACA

This pilgrimage involves passing through the valley of Baca – which means - the valley of weeping

Psalms 84:5-7

5 Blessed are those whose strength is in you, who have set their hearts on pilgrimage.

6 As they pass through the Valley of Baca, they make it a place of springs; the autumn rains also cover it with pools. 7 They go from strength to strength, till each appears before God in Zion. NIV

God's people have:

- Firmly committed their hearts on a pilgrimage to Jerusalem.

They are able:

- To make this place of weeping into a place of refreshment of springs of water.

They go from:

- **Strength to strength until they appear before God in Zion**

Psalms 84:5-7

5 Happy are the people whose strength is in You, whose hearts are set on pilgrimage. 6 As they pass through the Valley of Baca, they make it a source of springwater; even the autumn rain will cover it with blessings. 7 They go from strength to strength; each appears before God in Zion. Holman Bible

- ITS ABOUT STAYING **FOCUSED** ON **THE PILGRIMAGE** AND-FINISHING THE **PILGRIMAGE**.

- * But this can only be if we are not tricked into thinking the events experienced define what our life is. NO, they are only events experienced along our pilgrimage.

OUR DESTINATION IS:

Hebrews 12:22-24

22 But you have come to Mount Zion, to the heavenly Jerusalem, the city of the living God. You have come to thousands upon thousands of angels in joyful assembly, 23 to the church of the firstborn, whose names are written in heaven. You have come to God, the judge of all men, to the spirits of righteous men made perfect, 24 to Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel. NIV

- It's about the **exercising of our faith** in the knowledge that those events that happen in our lives along the way - **are only a PART OF** the pilgrims' journey and our life's experiences and not any one of those events **should be taken** as determining or defining a summary of our LIVES.
- **SADLY**, too many of us magnify one or more of these events in the pilgrimage to mean more than they are. They are nothing more than an event along the way.
- OUR TASK IS TO understand that we are just passing through this valley and we are to stay focused **on FINISHING THE PILGRIMAGE**.

THE VALLEY OF BACA- Valley of weeping

(Psalm 84:6). The word baca means "balsam" but is also the Hebrew verb for "**weep**." (The balsam tree "**weeps**" its resin.) **STACTE**

STACTE is in fact "**MYRRH**", and its Hebrew original, signifying "**drops**", probably refers to "**MYRRH WITH TEARS**".

The Hebrew word, **NATAF**, means "**DROPS**", and implies that it was one of those fragrant gums **which ooze in drops or tears**, from a variety of tropical or subtropical plants, and was used in the freely flowing myrrh found in the Holy anointing oil.

Stacte – "From the **myrrh**, when it is bruised flows an oil; it is in fact called "**stacte**" because **it comes in drops slowly**."

- **ALL BELIEVERS SHOULD LEARN TO WEEP – Weeping is not a sign of weakness - Jesus the strongest Wept John 11:35**

- **THERE ARE MANY REASONS WHY WE THE BELIEVER WEEPS**

We weep because

1. **We are sorry** for the sinful life and the transgressions we did before we experienced salvation
2. **We are sorrowful** for our foolish living and poor past decisions we have made.
3. **We are deeply sorrowful** for the sinner and his state without God and without hope
4. **We weep in** intercessory prayer for the saints according to Romans 8:26-27
5. **We are sorrowful** for those loved ones who have died, for various reasons.
6. **We are ALSO** filled with joy, appreciation, gratitude to Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ for the wonderful grace and mercy

- **ALL OF THESE REASONS ARE PART OF THE PILGRIMAGE THAT WE ARE ON TOWARDS GOD & ZION**

Hebrews 5:7 While Jesus lived on earth, he prayed to God and asked God for help. He prayed with loud cries and tears to the One who could save him from death, and his prayer was heard because he trusted God. NCV

DO NOT BE DISTRACTED OR DISTURBED BY **EVENTS THAT HAPPEN TO US** AS WE JOURNEY ON **OUR PILGRIMAGE TO ZION**.

Hebrews 12:22-24

22 But you have come to Mount Zion, to the heavenly Jerusalem, the city of the living God. You have come to thousands upon thousands of angels in joyful assembly, 23 to the church of the firstborn, whose names are written in heaven. You have come to God, the judge of all men, to the spirits of righteous men made perfect, 24 to Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel. NIV

IT IS ABOUT US SEEING LIFE'S EVENTS IN THE CONTEXT OF THE ENTIRE JOURNEY / PILGRIMAGE
Amen Ps Barry